QUAIN

NETWORKING

A small, *trusted* circle.

A professional foundation of trusted relationships that we build in good times, so we can rely on it when we need it.

Nicolas Moegelin · Berlin, Germany

Final presentation · Digitale Leute Product Management Bootcamp · 08–11 / 2026

QUAIN AT A GLANCE

Curated Seasons for *trusted* relationships.

Networking for **(senior) Product Professionals** that feels more like making friends.

Season

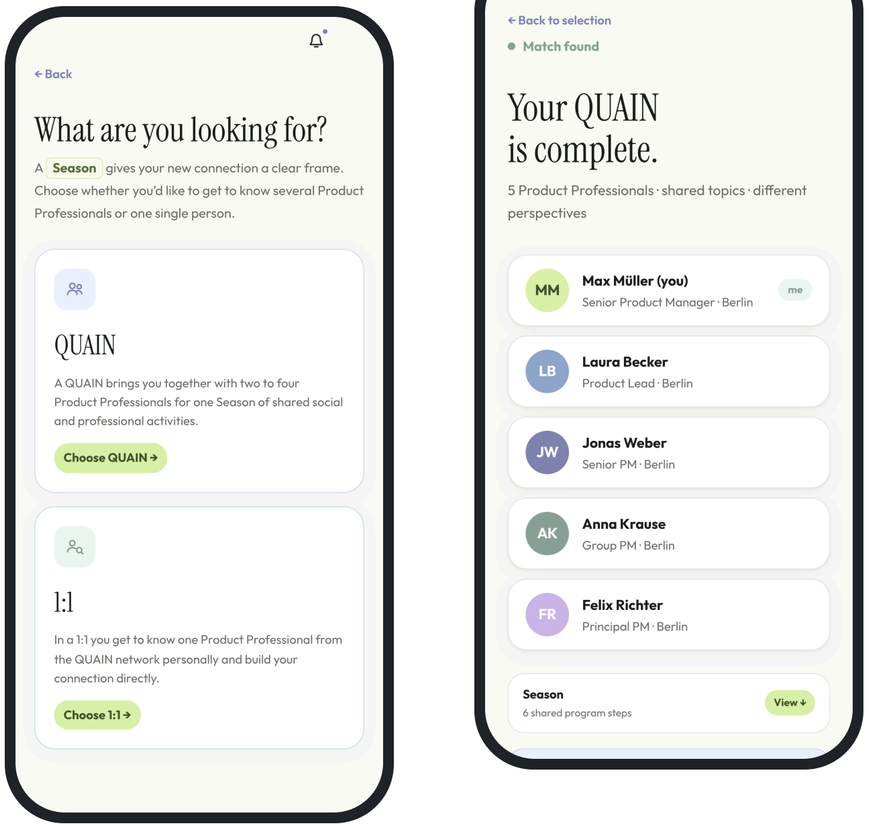
1:1s or 3–5	6 months	6 activities
people per Season	leave without guilt	no meeting vibe

VISION [2]

A professional foundation of trusted relationships that we build in good times, so we can rely on it when we need it.

MISSION [2]

As a digital curator, we use offline and online formats deliberately to create encounters that grow into reliable relationships rather than loose contacts.



[1]

THE PROBLEM

Out of *sight*, out of mind.

Valuable contacts get lost once shared work or occasions end and are missing later. [3]

3 OF 3 INTERVIEWS

"... [after a job or project change] it usually fizzles out after two years at the latest."

Interview 01 · translated [4]

1 OF 3 INTERVIEWS

"Yes, how do I tell him now [after a long time without contact] that I'm looking for a job, that's actually awkward."

Interview 01 · translated [4]

2 OF 3 INTERVIEWS

"... I always cancel the [monthly]. Somehow I can't cancel the series yet, because I don't dare to."

Interview 02 · translated [5]

WHAT HOLDS

"Our project lead is now [...] the one I [...] go running with, [...] that's how I talk through some things."

Interview 02 · translated [5]

TAKEAWAY

Shared activities *connect* and make room for professional exchange.

WHY IT MATTERS

Trusted connections raise *quality* and output.

Exchange among peers leads to new perspectives and speeds up professional growth. *That* is what customers pay for.

STUDIES · B2B2C AND B2C

Connection is linked to performance.

- More friendships in the team, better performance ratings. [18]
- Co-workers shape attitudes and effectiveness, not only leadership. [19]
- Teams with bridges to other teams are more innovative. [20]

INTERVIEW INSIGHT

"… [after talking to a colleague in the same role] I completely changed my strategy again, […] one I simply hadn't come up with myself."

Interview 03 · translated [21]

• THE SOLUTION

A circle with a beginning and an *end*.

Every Season has a fixed start, six activities and a clear ending that makes leaving easy. [7]

STEP 1/4

Choose 1:1 or group

STEP 2/4

Profile & matching [7]

1. Professional focus
2. Personal interests
3. Additional info

Based on this, QUAIN matches participants and creates activities.

STEP 3/4 **Season** · 6 months, 6 program steps



STEP 4/4

Leave or keep going [7]

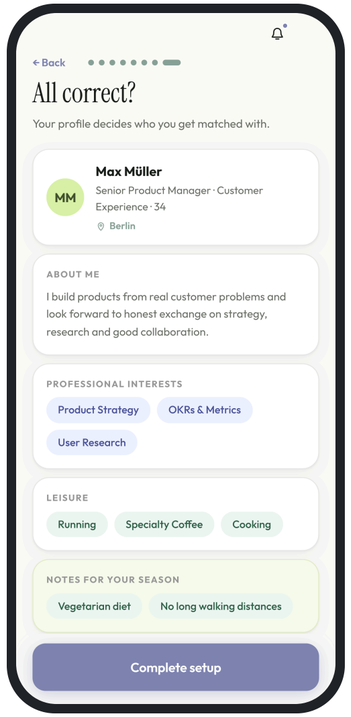
- Leave at the end of the program via the system, without an awkward goodbye
- Start a new Season

DESIGN PRINCIPLES [8]

No meeting feeling | Leaving without bad vibes | Confidentiality first

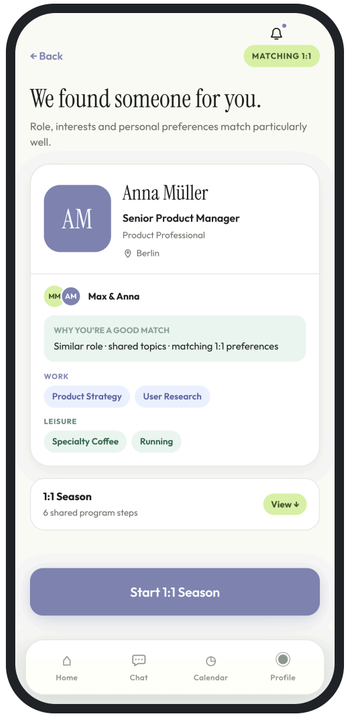
From profile to *Season*.

Clickable B2C prototype as the basis for the MVP. [7]



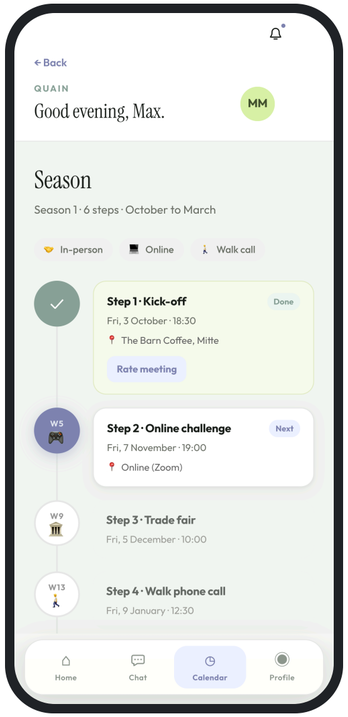
Preference profile

Professional focus and personal interests.



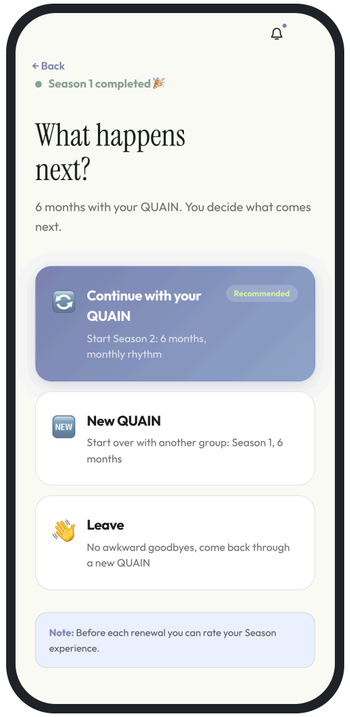
Matching

QUAIN shows what you have in common.



Planning

Date, place and format: QUAIN organises.



End of Season

Decide quietly: continue, new QUAIN or leave.

BUSINESS MODEL

B2C proves, B2B *scales*.

We start with private subscriptions and grow through companies that book places for their product teams.

B2C · GO-TO-MARKET

Private QUAIN

Who pays: the user

€9.90 per month
from Season start[7]

- Freemium: sign-up and contacts free of charge
- ≈ €118.80 per person and year
- Stays with you when you change jobs

≈ 139
private subscriptions equal one company customer

B2C → B2B

Happy users bring QUAIN into their company.

B2B2C · SCALING

Corporate QUAIN

Who pays: HR / Learning & Development

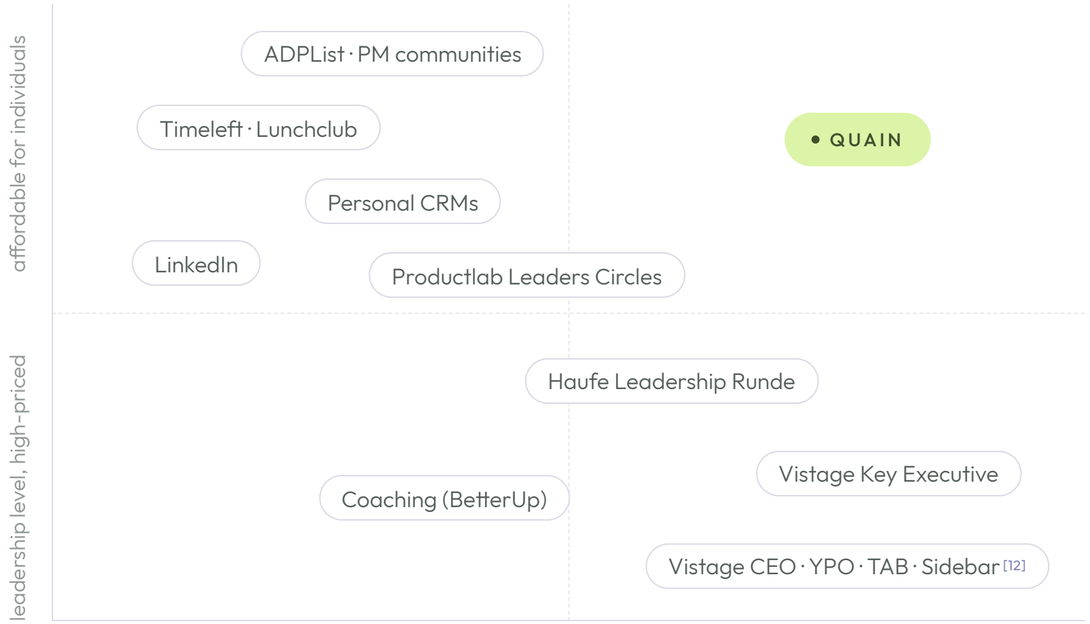
€75 per person and month
+ €250 base fee[13]

- Avg. 15 places ≈ €16,500 per company and year
- Pilot: one Season at €45 per person
- Employer sees no content

• COMPETITION

Proven mechanism, *new* goal.

Moderated C-level peer groups have existed for decades (YPO since 1950, Vistage since 1957), at C-level prices. [6, 12]



What QUAIN *combines*

A fixed small circle that experiences things together for a Season instead of holding meetings, with relationship as the goal, at a price for individuals and with a guilt-free exit after every Season.

Not found in this combination at any provider we examined (as of 11/2026). [6]

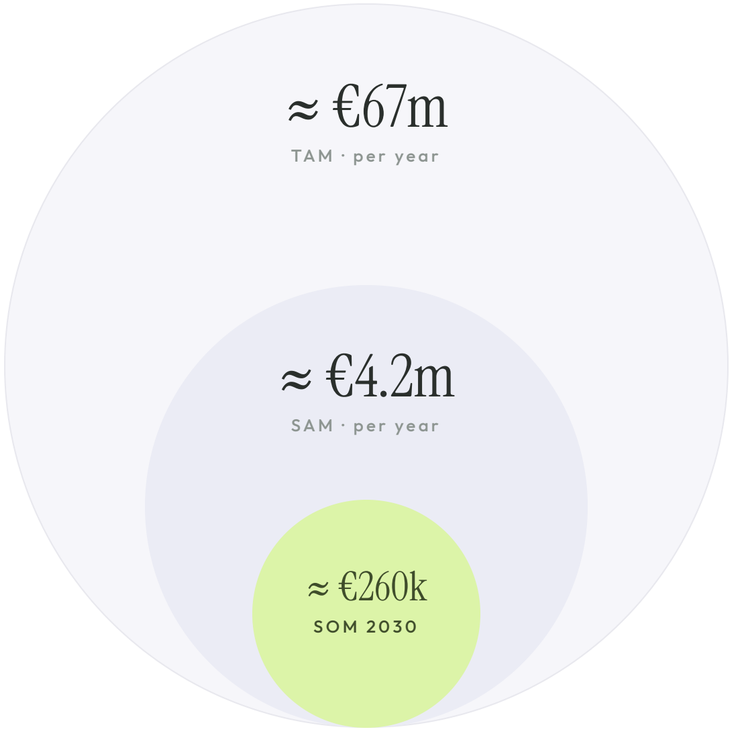
WHAT THE MARKET DOESN'T SOLVE · OWN ASSESSMENT

- **LinkedIn:** many loose contacts, labour-intensive (posting)
- **Events / meetups:** one-off, networking depends on personality
- **Personal CRMs:** create no shared moments
- **C-level peer forums:** exclusive (high costs) [6]

MARKET

≈ 35,000 senior PMs in *Germany* alone.

Planning assumption: a clear niche, large enough to grow city by city without venture capital.



TAM	**Product roles in Europe** 567,000 × €118.80 per year (12 × €9.90) ≈ €67m per year Assumption based on Product Focus, LinkedIn count 10/2023[9]	≈ 567,000 people
SAM	**Senior and aspiring-senior PMs in Germany** 100,000 product roles in DE × 35 % = 35,000 × €118.80 ≈ €4.2m per year Planning assumption: the Product Focus Survey 2026 reports 46 % senior PMs; because roles are self-assessed, we deduct about 10 percentage points[10, 11]	≈ 35,000 people
SOM 2030	**Paying B2C users + B2B company customers** B2C ≈ €95,000* + B2B €165,000** (10 companies) ≈ €260k per year * Assumption B2C: 5 cities × avg. 40 groups × avg. 4 people = 800 people × €9.90 × 12 months ≈ €95,000[10] ** Assumption B2B: 15 people × €75 × 12 months + €250 base fee × 12 months = €16,500 per company[13]	≈ 800 people + 10 companies

DELIVERY · RELEASE PLAN

From prototype to *market*, step by step.

Agile roadmap: *Now* in the next 3 months, *Next* in the next 6 months, *Later* after that. [22]

NOW — next 3 months

Prototype Validation
Test the Figma Make prototype with 8 people in interviews.
KPI drop-off rate · KAN-18–22

Build, Ship & Launch MVP
App on Supabase, Stripe for payments; iOS TestFlight and Google Play internal testing.
KPI retention rate · KAN-18–22

Testing
The MVP runs on all devices and operating systems without obstacles.
KPI conversion, retention · KAN-18–24

NEXT — next 6 months

GTM: Find the Watering Hole
First users in Berlin: two groups and two 1:1s, via online PM communities.
KPI conversion, retention · KAN-21, KAN-22

App Performance Monitoring
Detect problems and bugs early via Supabase and Stripe and fix them fast.

LATER — after 6 months

B2B Sales
First B2B2C pilot customer, based on B2C success.
KPI conversion, revenue growth, user count

Starting Ads
Ads in relevant communities, e.g. Reddit.
KPI conversion, retention

Let's get Trackin'
Tracking events for retention, churn and rating in the dashboard.
KPI retention, churn, 5-star rating

MVP · Release 1 — HIGH PRIORITY · IN PROGRESS

- Profile & sign-up
- 3 preferences in onboarding
- See & join groups
- Preferences in profile

Release 2 — MEDIUM PRIORITY · TO DO

Further user stories from the story map

SUCCESS CRITERIA

> 60 %	Retention rate: Seasons completed and renewed
< 5 %	Churn rate: drop-outs during a running Season
4 of 5	stars after every activity and every Season

Two futures, five *open* questions.

Two fictional interviews from 2036 show what has to work. [17]

BEST CASE

Julia K., 41

Senior Product Manager · HR tech scale-up, Berlin

"At some point, QUAIN became indispensable."

18 SEASONS IN NINE YEARS

Company insolvent, three conversations in one week.

Never organised anything, just showed up.

The end of the first circle didn't hurt.

Happily paid every month for 18 Seasons.

Berlin 2027: the first group starts.

OPEN QUESTION

H1 · H2
Does trust emerge that holds?

H3 · H4
Does a fixed program fit everyday life?

H5
Does leaving work without bad vibes?

H6
Does the value justify the monthly fee?

H8
Are there enough people per city?

WORST CASE

Daniel M., 44

Senior Product Manager · logistics SME, Cologne

"We were nice, but never honest."

NINE SEASONS IN EIGHT YEARS

Nine Seasons and no one I would call.

The dates were fixed, my calendar wasn't.

Started a new Season because the others probably would.

Paying for something like friendship doesn't fit.

Cologne 2028: the first QUAIN doesn't start.

CUSTOMER LONGEVITY

How do we keep interest and curiosity alive in the long run?

B2B WILLINGNESS TO PAY

Are companies / HR departments willing to pay?
If so, how much?

Where the *statements* come from.

Own artefacts with their path in the project repository, external sources also in the register quellen.md. Interview quotes translated from German.

[1] Clickable prototype (Figma Make): screens from the private (B2C) access with sample data
nmooh.github.io/quain · description in 02_define/prototyp/screens.md

[2] Product Vision Board: vision and mission
02_define/product-vision-board.md

[3] Synthesis of the interviews: core problems KP1–KP7, evidence H1 ●●◯, H2 ●●◯ (supported by three interviews, not validated)
02_define/Synthese/Interviews-synthese.md

[4] Interview 01, transcript (verbatim quotes, German)
01_discover/Interviews/interview-01/fathom-transkript.md

[5] Interview 02, transcript (verbatim quote, German)
01_discover/Interviews/interview-02/fathom-transkript.md

[6] Competitive analysis: 9 categories, white-space analysis, section 9 Germany (Vistage Key Executive, TAB, Haufe Leadership Runde, Productlab Leaders Circles; web research 2026-11-06, fact check 2026-11-10 incl. Deep Work Leadership Circle and Delight Path Product Leaders Lab); placement on slide 07 qualitative
01_discover/Marktanalyse/wettbewerbsanalyse.md

[7] Solution concept QUAIN V4: Season, vote, working prices (decisions 2026-10-28 and 2026-11-02)
04_develop/quain/quain.md

[8] Strategic anchor: design principles, OKR, USP
03_strategy/strategischer-anker.md

[9] Product Focus: Product Managers across the world, LinkedIn count 10/2023
productfocus.com · register 01_discover/sekundaerforschung/quellen.md

[10] Market & growth B2C/B2B: planning assumptions and calculation
03_strategy/markt-wachstum/ (build_markt_wachstum.py, one-pager)

[11] Product Focus Industry Survey Report 2026 (n = 677, 40 countries, self-assessed role: 46 % senior PM, 24 % head of and above)
productfocus.com · register quellen.md

[12] Vistage and YPO, self-reported: About Vistage (since 1957, ≈ 45,000 members), What is Vistage (groups of 12–16), Vistage “Best Leadership Training Companies” 04/2026 ($2,500 initiation + $1,380 per month ≈ $16,500 per year); About YPO (since 1950)
vistage.com · register quellen.md

[13] B2B offer: prices, base fee, pilot
03_strategy/b2b-angebot/b2b-angebot-onepager.html

[14] Strategy on one page: channels and target group
03_strategy/strategy.md

[15] B2C test Berlin: process and thresholds
03_strategy/b2c-test/b2c-test-onepager.html

[16] 1:1 self-test, own statement Nicolas (November 2026)
not documented in the repository

[17] PRFAQ: Working Backwards as a method
03_strategy/prfaq/quain-prfaq.md

[18] Methot, LePine, Podsakoff & Christian (2016): Are Workplace Friendships a Mixed Blessing? Personnel Psychology 69(2), n = 168/182, correlational
doi.org/10.1111/peps.12109

[19] Chiaburu & Harrison (2008): meta-analysis on the influence of co-workers, J. of Applied Psychology 93(5), 161 samples, 77,954 employees, correlational
doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.93.5.1082

[20] Yan, Venkataramani, Tang & Hirst (2024): Navigating Inter-Team Competition, J. of Applied Psychology, 73 teams (field) and 162 teams (experiment)
doi.org/10.1037/apl0001216

[21] Interview 03, transcript (verbatim quote, German, 35:26): evidence for change of perspective (KP5, ●◯◯, I03 only)
01_discover/Interviews/interview-03/fathom-transkript.md

[22] Agile roadmap (Now/Next/Later) and story map with releases, Miro (delivery exercise)
Miro board · not documented in the repository